

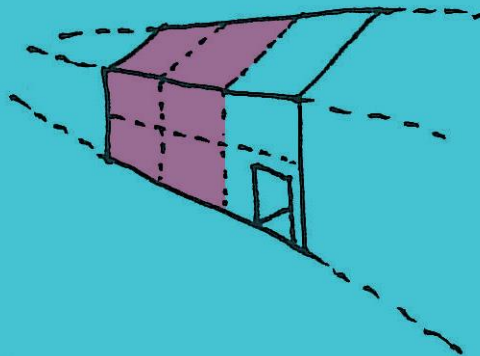
146-156 High Street West, Wallsend

NP10011

Design & Access Statement

- Proposed Retail and Residential Development
High Street West
Newcastle upon Tyne

June 2015



1. PROJECT INFORMATION

1.1 CLIENT

Mr J Singh

1.2 PROPERTY ADDRESS

146-156 High Street West
Wallsend
Newcastle upon Tyne
NE28 8HZ

1.3 PROJECT

Proposed Retail Units and Flats

1.4 DATE

June 2015

1.5 INTRODUCTION

The scheme comprises the demolition of a section of the existing terrace of retail units and construction of a new infill block of retail units at ground floor level with residential apartments above.

1.6 RELEVANT PLANNING HISTORY

This application is a resubmission of a previously approved application (ref: 14/01053/FUL) relating to no's 146-156 High Street West. The applicant is also proposing to demolish and re-build no. 158 High Street West which will be subject to a separate Full Planning Application.

The previous application (ref: 14/01053/FUL) was a new application submitted to supersede 13/00234/FUL after it was deemed that the existing buildings were in too poor condition to be suitable for conversion and therefore demolition would be required.

14/01053/FUL – Demolition of existing buildings and construction two storey retail/residential development comprising ground floor retail and first/second floors 6no flats. – Permitted 4th September 2014.

13/00234/FUL – Conversion of 4no ground floor retail units to 1no retail unit together with single storey rear extension and dormers to the front and rear elevations. Conversion of existing first floor office accommodation into 6no two storey residential apartments – Permitted 28th May 2013.

09/00754/FUL – Conversion of 4no ground floor retail units to 1no retail unit together with single storey rear extension. Converting existing first floor office accommodation into 6no two storey residential apartments - Permitted 4th September 2009.

Although not directly relating to the proposed site, the application below (ref:14/01650/FUL) is for the large scale redevelopment of an area of land on the opposite side of High Street West as a retail centre and drive through restaurant.

14/01650/FUL – Erection of convenience foodstore (Class A1) and single-storey drive-thru restaurant (Class A3) and associated landscaping, car parking, servicing and access arrangements. – Permitted 19th January 2014.

1.7 PLANNING POLICY

Planning Applications are to be considered against the National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF) and relevant policies from the Unitary Development Plan (UDP) for North Tyneside.

Policies from the North Tyneside UDP which are relevant to this application include:

- S2 Promote good quality and safe environment in shopping centres.
- S3/4 Support proposals which will result in the full use of upper floors in town centres including residential.
- H11 Requirement for high standard of design.
- H13 Non-residential developments within residential areas to be approved where they would not adversely affect the residential amenity.
- LDD11 Design Quality Supplementary Planning Document (SDP).
- LDD12 Transport and Highways SDP.

2. SITE ANALYSIS AND APPRAISAL

2.1 LOCATION

The site is located on the south side of High Street West within the boundaries of Wallsend Town Centre.

The subject site for this application is demarked in pink below with the adjacent separate application for no. 158 demarked in blue which is also owned by the applicant.



Site aerial view

2.2 SITE AREA

545m²

2.3 EXISTING BUILDINGS

The existing two-storey, mid-terrace properties were in a very poor condition and have been demolished in May 2015 on health and safety grounds. Previously the building comprised 4no. retail units at ground floor level with ancillary office / storage accommodation above. The building was of traditional masonry construction with glazed shop fronts, a render finish and tiled roof. One and two storey brick extensions were present to the rear with a hardstanding yard area.

2.4 SITE PHOTOS – PRIOR TO DEMOLITION



Front elevation prior to demolition



Rear elevation prior to demolition

2.5 SITE PHOTOS – FOLLOWING DEMOLITION



Front elevation following demolition



Rear elevation following demolition

3. DESIGN PROPOSALS

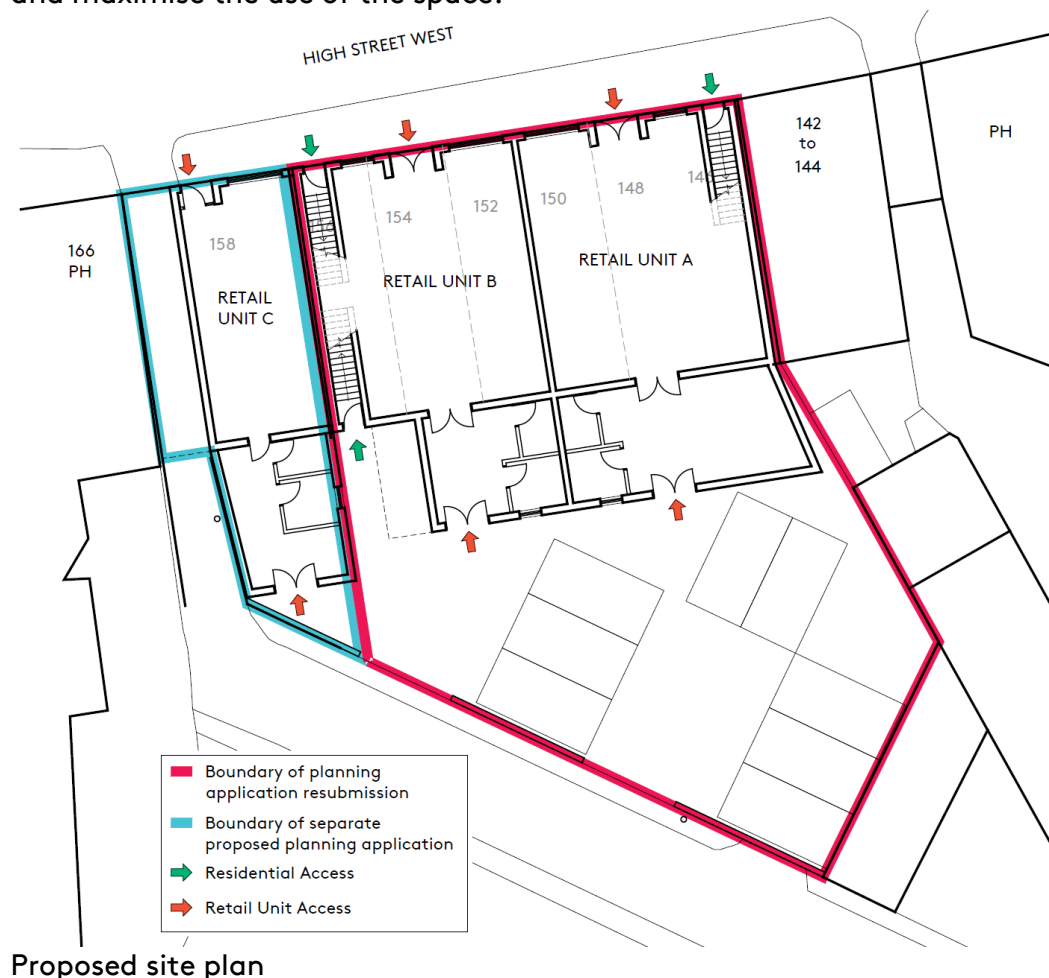
3.1 DEVELOPMENT DESCRIPTION AND OBJECTIVES

As a resubmission of the previous application, the scale, heights and general accommodation will match the previously approved application as well as the existing buildings. The proposal will infill the gap left in the terrace following demolition and run flush with the front and rear building lines of no. 142/144 and no. 160. (with the redevelopment of no. 158 subject to a separate application).

3.2 LAYOUT

The ground floor will be split into 2no. retail units with a single storey rear extension to the rear providing storage and staff welfare facilities. The front elevation will include 2no. entrance doors to the upper floors' residential accommodation with an additional residential entrance to the rear providing access to the rear yard parking, cycle and refuse stores.

In accordance with the previously approved planning application, 6no. residential flats will be situated on the first floor and within the second floor roof space with dormer windows required to facilitate the practical use of the loft space. The internal design of the apartments has been amended to rationalise the layout and maximise the use of the space.



3.3 APPEARANCE

The amendments to the internal layouts have resulted in some alterations to the fenestration and shop fronts. Materials will consist of facing brick, render and roof tiles to match existing with aluminium framed glazed shop fronts and windows with integrated perforated roller shutters to the shopfronts.

The proportions of the shop fronts and more contemporary dormer windows improve the proposed elevations providing a more attractive street frontage which will reflect the proposed new shopping development opposite.



Proposed High Street West Elevation

3.4 SUSTAINABILITY

The thermal envelope and M&E installations in the building will be in line with the latest Building Control requirements. Should the planning application be approved, a specialist engineer will be consulted to assess the practical and economic viability of renewable energy sources such as air source heat pumps and/or photovoltaics. Any such installations will be subject to statutory approval.

3.5 IMPACT

The existing building was in an extremely poor state of repair and had a negative visual impact on the streetscape as well as posing potential health and safety risks to the public. It has therefore been demolished prior to rebuilding.

The proposed development will infill the existing terrace with the eaves and ridge lines to line through with the adjacent properties. The materials will match those existing on the street while the design has been carefully considered to provide a more contemporary aesthetic to the street frontage.

4. ACCESS

4.1 VEHICULAR AND TRANSPORT LINKS

The site is located on High Street West which is a main arterial route into Newcastle city centre and provides excellent vehicular, public transport, cycling and pedestrian links.

4.2 PARKING, DELIVERIES AND REFUSE COLLECTION

The rear yard includes 8no. parking spaces; however, 2no. space will be allocated for use by the adjacent development of no. 158. Therefore 6no. spaces will be provided for the 6no. one bedroom apartments which is in line with the previously approved application.

At the time of this application the future tenants for the retail units are unknown so it is not possible to ascertain the exact delivery requirements.

Facilities for the storage of refuse for the retail and residential units are incorporated within the plans to the rear of the property.

4.3 INCLUSIVE ACCESS

Access into and within the building will be in accordance with Approved Document Part M and the Equality Act 2010. Level thresholds will be provided at the entrances. The scale of the development and restrictions of the building envelope means that lift provision for the first floor flats is not economically or practically viable.

5. CONCLUSIONS

5.1 SUMMARY

The applicant is proposing to demolish and reconstruct a series of mid-terrace retail units with the proposed addition of residential apartments above.

The external appearance of the building will be within the massing of the existing building and previously approved proposals. The designs have been slightly amended to improve the functionality of the internal layout and the design quality of the external elevations.

The location benefits from excellent vehicular, public transport and pedestrian links and the building will be designed to provide inclusive access.

The proposed development will replace the previous poor quality, vacant building and provide a positive contribution to the character and economy of the local area.